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Lead Technical Architect

Maritime and Coastguard Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Wednesday 8th July 2026



Maritime &
Coastguard
Agency

Reference number

467140

Salary

£57,515

DDaTt Allowances up to £24,915

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

MCA - Information Technology

Type of role

Architecture and Data
Information Technology

Working pattern

Full-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Southampton

About the job

Job summary

Can you turn complex business problems into innovative, high-impact technical designs that shape the MCA's digital future?

Do you want to influence senior stakeholders, set architectural standards, and drive technology strategy across a national organisation?

If so, we'd love to hear from you!

The MCA Architecture & Engineering function enables the organisation to deliver world class services as a coastal state and search & rescue capability in UK waters. It is a centre of excellence that is responsible for the technology strategy, delivering a broad portfolio of change to transform the Agency's existing technologies, and deliver innovative new solutions designed around our business needs.

The architecture team is responsible for the definition of the Maritime and Coastguard Agency technology strategy, the development of the solutions architectures required to realise this strategy and ensuring that architecture

and technology principles are met and maintained. Joining our department comes with many benefits, including:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [here](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Read more in the Benefits section below!

Find out more about what it's like working at: [Maritime and Coastguard Agency - Department for Transport Careers](#)

Job description

As a Lead Technical Architect (Networks), you will provide technical leadership and architectural design. You will work with multiple projects and teams on problems that require broad architectural thinking.

Your responsibilities will include, but aren't limited to:

1. Undertake analysis of current network infrastructure within the business, translating this analysis into technology roadmaps and designs that describe the possible solutions and technology choices.
2. Engage with design and delivery partners to ensure low-level designs are created, be consulted on design decisions, and provide design guidance.
3. Manage the network infrastructure portfolio for the Maritime & Coastguard Agency and identify deeper technology issues in existing systems that need may need fixing.
4. Communicate the technology roadmap for Network Infrastructure with both technical and non-technical stakeholders.
5. You will also need to ensure that the knowledge of the MCA architecture is maintained in the architecture repository as well as be compliant with the architecture strategy and principles.
6. Be responsible for leading the technical design of systems and services, justifying and communicating design decisions.

7. Assure other services and system quality, ensuring the technical work fits into the broader strategy for government
8. Provide leadership to other architects.

Great line management is important to us as an organisation, and we will equip and support line managers to develop the skills they need. We aim to empower line managers to create teams where people can flourish and deliver excellent outcomes for the public.

For further information on the role, please read the role profile. Please note that the role profile is for information purposes only - whilst all elements are relevant to the role, they may not all be assessed during the recruitment process. This job advert will detail exactly what will be assessed during the recruitment process.

Person specification

Essential licenses:

1. A full UK driving license

You will be required to provide evidence that you hold any essential licenses at some point during the recruitment process. If you cannot provide evidence, your application will be withdrawn.

Required experience:

To be successful in this role you will need to have the following experience:

A functional appreciation of the application and technology architecture domains;

A strong understanding of deployment models, including; Serverless computing, and Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS);

Strong experience of architecture methodology and tools, design and modelling techniques, and best practice;

You will be expert in turning business problems into technical design and can design systems characterised by high levels of risk, impact and business or technical complexity;

You will be proficient in evolving and defining governance and take responsibility for collaborating and supporting services in wider governance;

You will be proficient in defining and challenging strategies, patterns, standards, policies, roadmaps and vision statements

Additional Information

The role is part of the [Government Digital and Data \(or Government Security Profession Career Framework\) profession](#) and utilises an enhanced Capability Based Pay Framework which provides access to a Digital and Data allowance.

The base pay is £57,515. In addition to this, the role attracts a DDaT pay allowance that is assessed at Interview, and can increase pay up to a maximum of £82,430, the additional allowance is non-pensionable and is dependent on a score assessed during the interview process.

The value of allowance awarded will be based on an assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated through the selection process. [Here are more details on the pay framework.](#)

Working hours, office attendance and travel requirements

Full time roles consist of 37 hours per week. This role **is suitable** for hybrid working, which is a non-contractual arrangement where a combination of workplace and home-based working can be accommodated subject to business requirements.

The expectation at present is a minimum of 60% of your working time a week will be spent at either your designated workplace (one of the locations cited in the advert) or, when required for business reasons, in another office/ work location/visiting stakeholders. Your designated workplace will be your contractual place of work. There may be occasions where you are required to attend above the minimum expectation.

Occasional travel to other offices will be required, which may involve overnight stays.

If you have a question about hybrid working, part time/job share hours, flexible working, travelling for work, or require a reasonable adjustment, please contact the Vacancy Holder during the recruitment process to avoid possible disappointment later in the process should your working arrangements not be compatible with the requirements of the role (see below for contact details).

Visa Sponsorship

Please note that we will only offer sponsorship for a skilled worker visa where a role has been deemed to be business critical. This role does not meet that category, and **we will not sponsor a visa**. Therefore, this role is not open to applications from those who require sponsorship – candidates must ensure they have the appropriate right to work in the UK before applying. Should you apply for this role and be found to require sponsorship, your application will be rejected and any provisional offer of employment withdrawn.

Security Checks

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check. Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is SC (Security Clearance)

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Licences

Full UK Driving License at the point of application

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Seeing the Big Picture

Changing and Improving

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Architect for the whole context

Architecture Communication

Community Collaboration

Strategy Design

Technical Design throughout the lifecycle

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £57,515, Maritime and Coastguard Agency contributes £16,662 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Being part of our brilliant Civil Service means you will have access to a wide range of fantastic benefits:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [here](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave).

8 Bank Holidays plus an additional Privilege Day to mark the King's birthday.

Access to the staff discount portal.

Excellent career development opportunities and the potential to undertake professional qualifications relevant to your role paid for by the department, such as CIPD, Prince2, apprenticeships, etc.

Joining a diverse and inclusive workforce with a range of staff communities to support all our colleagues.

24-hour Employee Assistance Programme providing free confidential help and advice for staff.

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Find out more about the [benefits of working at MCA](#) (opens in a new window).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

How to apply:

Our selection process ensures a comprehensive assessment of each applicant's, skills, and potential fit within our organisation.

The selection process for this role will be:

Stage 1: Sift of CV and personal statement

Stage 2: Microsoft Teams Interview

Stage 3: Interview

You must be successful at each stage to progress to the next stage.

Stage 1: Sift

At sift, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Experience you will be asked to provide a CV (unlimited wordcount) and personal statement (1000-word count). Please provide evidence of your Experience of the following:

1. Network Architecture or Design at scale
2. Evidence of Lifecycle Management in complex network environment incorporating segmentation to support a Zero Trust Network environment
3. Evidence of industry and vendor best practice across network designs

The sift will take place commencing 9th July

Stage 2: Microsoft Teams Interview.

At first interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Behaviours Making Effective Decisions and Communicating and Influencing

Stage 3: Interview and Presentation

At the second interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Behaviours

Seeing The Big Picture,

Changing and Improving, Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Technical - DDAT Framework

Architect for the whole context Skill level: Practitioner (linked with seeing the big picture behaviour)

Architecture Communication - Skill level: Expert

Community Collaboration - Skill level - Practitioner

Strategy Design - Skill level: Practitioner

Technical Design throughout the lifecycle - Skill level: Expert

Government Digital and Data Profession Capability Framework - Government Digital and Data Profession Capability Framework

You will also be required to create and deliver a presentation to assess the Behaviour making effective decisions and the Technical skill of Architecture Communication.

Guidance will be provided if you are invited to interview.

The interviews will take place week commencing 20th July

This interview will be conducted in person at our Southampton office. Further details will be provided to you should you be selected for interview.

Reasonable Adjustments

As a Disability Confident Leader employer, we are committed to ensuring that the recruitment process is fair, accessible and allows all candidates to perform at their best. If a person with a visible or non-visible disability is substantially disadvantaged, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need during the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at an interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

If you need a reasonable adjustment so that you can complete your application, you should contact Government Recruitment Service via dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Document Accessibility

This job advert contains links to the [DfT Careers website](#). Our website provides useful guidance and information that can support you during the application process. If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert or the information on our website, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

Further Information

For more information about how we hire, and for useful tips on submitting your application for this role, visit the [How We Hire](#) page of our DfT Careers website. You can find detailed information about the recruitment process and what to expect when applying for a role.

If your application is successful but you have been dismissed from the Civil Service, your application could be removed at the pre-employment checking stage depending on the nature of the dismissal.

This role is full time only. Applicants who wish to work an alternative pattern are welcome to apply however your preferred working pattern may not be available and you should discuss this with the vacancy holder before applying.

Pre-employment Checking

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

All External applicants and current employees of accredited non-departmental public bodies (NDPBs) will be required to undergo a Social Media Check. A Social Media Check is a review of your publicly available online activity, typically across platforms like LinkedIn, Facebook, X (formerly Twitter), Instagram, and others. The purpose is to identify any public posts or content that could raise concerns for employers, such as:

Hate speech or discriminatory behaviour

Threats or acts of violence

Illegal activity or substance misuse

Sexually explicit material

Extremist views or affiliations

Importantly, this check does not involve hacking into your accounts or accessing private messages. It only considers content you have chosen to make public.

Employers use this kind of screening to help ensure their workplace remains safe, inclusive, and aligned with company values. It's not about judging your personality or lifestyle – it's about checking for potential red flags that might affect the role or company culture.

If you have questions or concerns about the social media check, we would be happy to explain in more detail what's being looked at and how your data is handled securely and fairly.

Vetting

For further information on National Security Vetting please [visit the Demystifying Vetting website](#).

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application

for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : HR Resourcing

Email : hr.resourcing@mcga.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact Government Recruitment Services via email: dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Visit the Civil Service Commission website [Here](#)

